

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Job interviews can be difficult.



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe issues relating to money, in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How do you feel when go for a job interview?
- What questions do you have problems answering? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can exchange complex information about my work.
- I can explain how to present a good interview.
- I can report what someone had previously said.





Let's Explore!

Kristi wants to know about Adam's interview!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Adam:** Kristi, I was just approached by a recruitment agency. They told me they were looking for someone to fill a new position.
- Kristi:** That's great, Adam. How did it go?
- Adam:** I was very nervous and it was a difficult interview. It was my first interview here.
- Kristi:** You're such a composed guy.
- Adam:** I felt like there was a frog in my throat. My heart was beating a mile a minute.
- Kristi:** You're funny. Tell me more about the interview.
- Adam:** They said it was an interview for a full-time position. Most of my experience has been with part-time jobs.
- Kristi:** I see. What kind of questions did they ask you?
- Adam:** They asked me what my strengths and weaknesses were. I may have come off as a little overconfident. I tried too hard to impress and never mentioned any weaknesses.
- Kristi:** Uh oh. You don't want to be a blowhard. A recruiter told me it's good to be modest and have a quiet confidence.
- Adam:** They asked why I'd left my last job. They put me on the spot!
- Kristi:** What did you say?
- Adam:** I tried not to beat around the bush. I told them straight out that I left because my ex-boss was a jerk.
- Kristi:** Ouch! It's okay to be honest about what happened. But don't offer up any negative details. It doesn't look good on you.
- Adam:** I know. Needless to say, that was not my best interview. But you live and learn.
- Kristi:** That's the spirit. There are tons of jobs out there, so roll up your sleeves and let's get busy. I will do some research and help you with your interviews. I will also be helping me as I have a few coming up.
- Adam:** Thanks again, Kristi.



Let's Practice!

Adam was interviewed for a position!

Instructions: Classify the sentences into the correct category.

1. Tell me more about the interview.
2. They asked why I'd left my last job.
3. I told them straight out that I left because my ex-boss was a jerk.
4. I will do some research and help you with your interviews.
5. They told me they were looking for someone to fill a new position.
6. They said it was an interview for a full-time position.
7. I felt like there was a frog in my throat.

Reported speech

Direct speech



Let's Practice!

Adam tells Kristi all about his interview!

Instructions: Read the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. I was very nervous and it was a difficult interview.
2. It was my first interview here.
3. You're such a composed guy.
4. I tried hard to impress and never mentioned any weaknesses.
5. Needless to say, that was not my best interview. But you live and learn.
6. That's the spirit. There are tons of jobs out there, so roll up your sleeves and let's get busy.





Extension Activity

Role play an interview

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- You are going to interview and be interviewed by a partner.
- Research job interview questions and choose 5 - 7 questions to ask.
- Practice asking and answering questions with a partner.
- When you are finished, give your partner some feedback.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research job interview questions.

☐ ☐

I ask and answer job interview questions.

☐ ☐

I give my partner feedback on their answers.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to fill a position** (expression): to hire someone for a specific job
e.g. They told me they were looking for someone to fill a new position.
- **recruitment agency** (noun): a company that is paid to find workers for other companies
e.g. I was just approached by a recruitment agency.
- **composed** (adjective): calm and in control
e.g. You're such a composed guy because you never appear to be nervous.
- **overconfident** (adjective): having too much confidence
e.g. I may have come off as a little overconfident.
- **blowhard** (noun): a person who enjoys talking about how important they are
e.g. You don't want to be a blowhard.
- **modest** (adjective): quiet about one's abilities or achievements
e.g. A recruiter told me it's good to be modest and have a quiet confidence.
- **to put someone on the spot** (expression): to make someone uncomfortable by asking them to answer a difficult question
e.g. They asked why I'd left my last job. They put me on the spot.
- **to beat around the bush** (expression): to speak indirectly about something
e.g. I tried not to beat around the bush by telling them straight out that I left because my ex-boss was a jerk.
- **to roll up your sleeves** (expression): to get to work
e.g. There are tons of jobs out there, so roll up your sleeves and let's get busy.





Learning Points

Tonic, Emphatic and New Information Stress

Here we are looking at three types of stress, Tonic, emphatic, and stress for new information.

Tonic stress refers to the syllable in a word which receives the most stress in an intonation unit.

Example:

*I was just **approached** /*

*I was just **approached** / by a **recruitment agency**.*

To emphasize a word, you can change the stress from the principal word to another content word. By choosing a word other than the one you normally stress, you put emphasis on the new one.

Example:

*It was my first **interview** here. - Standard statement*

*It was my **first** interview here.- Emphasizes it was the first ever.*

*I tried to hard to impress and **never** mentioned any weaknesses.*

*I tried to hard to impress and never mentioned any **weaknesses** .*

When you **stress new information**, you pronounce new information with more breath force, since it is more prominent.

*They said it was an interview for a **full-time** position.*

*Most of my experience has been with **part-time** jobs.*





Learning Points

Reported Speech

You use reported speech when you are saying (reporting) what other people said.

When you tell people what someone has said in the past, you generally make the verb tense 'more in the past'. You need to change the verb to the next past form.

For example:

Direct speech

- *They are looking for someone to fill a new position.*

Reported speech

*They **told** me they were looking for someone to fill a new position.*

When changing sentences from direct speech, check if you have to change the following:

- pronouns (I said → He said)
- Present tense verbs
- Place and time expressions
- Tenses (backshift → change to the past)

Some reporting verbs and expressions commonly used are: **say**, **tell**, and **ask**.

Examples:

- *They **said** it was an interview for a full-time position.*
- *They **asked** me what my strengths and weaknesses were.*
- *They **asked** why I'd left my last job.*
- *I **told** them straight out that I left because my ex-boss was a jerk.*

